

VINCENT THOMAS

STORYTELLER, JOURNALIST, CONTENT DESIGNER and STRATEGIST

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Dynamic Content Writer/Editor/Designer/Strategist, Journalist, Storyteller and Project Manager with over 20 years of experience leading all aspects of content lifecycles. A tech-savvy, multi-tasking and deliverables-driven professional, bringing a passion for audience-driven content, cross-departmental collaboration, and user experience. A communications stalwart helping drive business-aligning strategies, tell stories, increase engagement and build brand awareness.

- **Proficiencies:** Google Suite; Microsoft 365; Adobe Creative Suite; Google Analytics; Content Management Systems (WordPress, Drupal); project management tools (Trello, Monday.com); Figma; and LLM and AI tools
- **Resource links:** [Portfolio](#). [LinkedIn](#).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Content Designer/Writer, Microsoft (contract), Atlanta, GA (2022-2023, 2025-present)

- Developed and refined content across multiple formats, including product pages, launch communications, executive communications, promotional materials, and e-books. for Microsoft 365 and Azure products, as part
- Provided content design tactical expertise, ongoing editorial support, and content strategy and design leadership for Microsoft Developer Division content that included product marketing pages, product launch pages, B2B customer success stories, technical blogs, and internal communications.
- Collaborated closely with cross-functional partners and stakeholders including product and project managers, engineers and developers, designers, and engagement, legal and accessibility teams in a highly matrixed and agile environment.
- Applied user research and competitive differentiation insights to drive audience-focused content initiatives.
- Helped develop a customer story SOP and product page template team members and non-content partners to establish best practices.
- Created a content hub for partners, stakeholders and new hires, which included curated resources, learning tools, and protocol guidance to facilitate asynchronous collaboration, amplify general knowledge and streamline onboarding.

AI Chatbot Trainer, Outlier (contributor), Atlanta, GA (2024 – present)

- Review and evaluate AI-generated prompts and responses for accuracy, relevance, clarity and tone, providing detailed feedback to improve the system's overall performance. Clients include many of the world's largest tech companies.

Content Design and Strategy Consultant, Freelance, New York, NY (2018 – present)

- Contributed to content strategy workbooks, audits, site refreshes, style manuals, B2B marketing collateral, audience research, social engagement and SEO strategies, email campaigns, product marketing and public relations for high-profile clients, including J.P. Morgan Chase, Synchrony Bank, National Urban League, and Buffalo Public Schools.
- Formulated mission, vision, and value statements based on user research insights and organizational business goals.
- Crafted audience personas, journey maps, and page table templates to facilitate content creation.
- Trained small staffs on CRM and CMS management strategies and best practices.

Editorial Director, Vox Media (SB Nation), Washington, D.C. (2016-2017)

- Developed and spearheaded sitewide content strategy guides, playbooks and roadmaps, and a style guide to help steer the production of diverse content formats for SB Nation, Vox Media's sports news and culture vertical.
- Spearheaded the implementation of a staff-wide pitch SOP, editorial calendar, and ideas warehouse.
- Transformed the audience development, SEO and social engagement strategies to enhance reach and impact.
- Managed and partnered with a team of 20 staff editors and writers and dozens of commissioned freelance contributors.
- Conducted user research, content design A/B tests and participated in scrum sprints for the SB Nation site refresh.
- Facilitated bi-weekly stakeholder meetings with the Executive Editor, Design Director, Video Chief and Engagement Editor and Community Lead.

Senior Editor, ESPN, Washington, DC (2016)

- A senior stakeholder responsible for launching The Undefeated, ESPN's sports and culture vertical.
- Built content packages with photos, headlines, tags, notifications, and any other requirements for publishing.
- Partnered with sales team to contribute editorial content support for ESPN mother site promotional partner packages.
- Innovated strategies for site design, editorial voice, audience development, and social engagement.

Special Projects Editor, Bleacher Report, New York, NY (2014-2016)

- Shepherded, wrote, copy edited, and assigned multi-format/platform premium content.
- Key stakeholder for populating and tracking the departmental editorial calendar and maintaining style guide standards.
- Collaborated with analytics and engagement stakeholders to conduct audits, and maintain and monitor metrics and KPIs.

- Conducted bi-weekly meetings for key senior stakeholders – including the President, SVP of Content, Executive VP of Programming, Art Director, and Leead Sales corporate liaison – to pitch, approve and track special projects content.
- Created and implemented the process for a revolving Writers’ Room and a cross-departmental Editorial Board.
- Led monthly open-invite brainstorm sessions to engage staff and democratize ideas funnelling to Special Projects.

EARLY CAREER

Editor-in-Chief, The Shadow League, New York, NY (2012-2013)

- Developed the editorial vision, strategy, and content planning for a new media startup.
- Significantly increased site traffic and engagement, maintaining an average of 2 million page views per month.
- Acted as the Editorial Lead for two rounds of seed funding.
- Partnered with the CEO and VP of Sales to establish editorial and advertising partnerships.

Content Creator and Feature Writer, Freelance, New York, NY (2007-2012)

- Composed magazine profiles, digital columns, and essays for various mainstream media outlets.
- Partnered with sales and account management teams to ensure **brand** needs were met.
- Edited features and titles for syntax, grammar, and format.

Editor, ThisIsRealMusic.com, New York, NY (2006-2008)

- Shaped, defined, and implemented the site’s editorial strategy, **brand** voice, and positioning.
- Increased audience and drive user engagement by 45% through big-picture planning.
- Led a diverse team of 15 full-time employees including freelance writers, editors, and reviewers.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to help drive SEO, video, email, and social strategies.
- Utilized data to identify new opportunities including editorial gaps, tools, and content partnerships.

Newspaper Editor and Reporter, Tampa Bay Times, Tampa, FL (2005-2006)

- Managed a team of 3 editorial staff members.
- Covered sports, local politics, and community events.
- Proofread and copy edited stringer submissions.
- Helped design the bureau front page each day.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

Content Strategy and Storytelling Certificate , University of Washington	2021
Bachelor of Arts (BA) in Journalism , Howard University	2004

Vincent Thomas

- Atlanta, GA, US

Contact Information

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Summary

Journalist and Content Strategist with over 15 years of experience leading all aspects of content lifecycles. Communications stalwart driving strategies targeted at increasing engagement, leads, and building **brand** awareness. A new media leader developing and executing content plans from conception through growth. A multi-tasking and deliverables-driven project manager, bringing a passion for storytelling, cross-functional collaboration, strategy, and user experience.

Work History

Total Work Experience: 11 years

- **Content Studio Editor/Writer (Consultant) Microsoft**
Jan 01, 2025
- **AI Chatbot Trainer (Contractor) Outlier**
Jan 01, 2024
- **Content Writer, Designer And Strategist (Contractor) Microsoft**
Jan 01, 2022
- **Content Strategist (Contractor) Synchrony**
Sep 01, 2021
- **Content And Communications Consultant Independent Contractor**
Jan 01, 2018

- **Communications Director Buffalo Urban League**
Jun 01, 2017
- **Editorial Director Vox Media**
Jan 01, 2016
- **Special Projects Editor Bleacher Report**
Jan 01, 2014

Education

- **Pre-Masters** | University of Washington
- **Bachelors** | Howard University

Skills

- content **writing** - 20 years
- editorial - 20 years
- **proofreading** - 20 years
- audience research - 15 years
- content **editing** - 15 years
- content strategy - 15 years
- cross departmental collaboration - 15 years
- search engine optimization - 13 years
- content development - 12 years
- user research - 12 years
- **brand** storytelling - 10 years
- content audits - 10 years
- content calendar planning - 10 years
- good practice - 10 years
- information architecture - 10 years
- management - 10 years
- personas - 10 years
- content creation - 8 years
- content management system - 8 years
- customer relationship management - 8 years
- email marketing - 8 years
- journey mapping - 8 years

- **market research** - 8 years
- **public relations** - 8 years
- **artificial intelligence** - 2 years
- **chatbot** - 2 years
- **adobe creative suite 6** - 1 years
- **drupal** - 1 years
- **figma** - 1 years
- **google analytics** - 1 years
- **google workspace** - 1 years
- **large language model** - 1 years
- **monday.com** - 1 years
- **project management** - 1 years
- **trello** - 1 years
- **wordpress** - 1 years
- **ap style**
- **audience development**
- **blogging**
- **copy editing**
- **copywriting**
- **corporate communications**
- **creative writing**
- **customer engagement**
- **digital media**
- **editing**
- **facebook**
- **feature articles**
- **feature writing**
- **journalism**
- **long form**
- **magazines**
- **media relations**
- **new media**
- **news writing**
- **newspapers**
- **online content creation**
- **online journalism**
- **press releases**
- **public speaking**
- **publications**
- **social media**
- **social media marketing**
- **storytelling**
- **strategic communications**
- **strategic planning**
- **strategy**

- style guides
- user experience
- web content creation
- web content **writing**
- **writing**
- collaboration - 7 years
- product marketing **writing** - 5 years
- accessibility - 2 years
- agile - 2 years
- customer success - 2 years
- management communication - 2 years
- mentoring - 2 years
- **microsoft** 365 - 2 years
- **microsoft** azure - 2 years
- onboarding - 2 years
- product development - 2 years
- user stories - 2 years
- content management systems - 15 years
- business intelligence - 5 years
- ab testing - 2 years
- playbooks - 2 years
- scrum - 2 years
- data analytics - 3 years
- performance metrics - 3 years
- web design - 1 years
- account management - 6 years

Work Preferences

- Desired Work Settings: No Preference
- Likely to Switch: True
- Willing to Relocate: False
- Travel Preference: 0%
- Work Authorization:
 - US
- Work Documents:
 - US Citizen
- Security Clearance: False
- Desired Salary: 90,000+ (USD)
- Third Party: False
- Employment Type:
 - Full-time

- Part-time
- Contract - Corp-to-Corp
- Contract - Independent
- Contract - W2
- Contract to Hire - Corp-to-Corp
- Contract to Hire - Independent
- Contract to Hire - W2

Profile Sources

- linkedin: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/vincent-thomas-65892955>
- facebook: <https://facebook.com/vincecathomas>
- Dice: <https://www.dice.com/employer/talent/profile/f9f8dfd37ab89e987b19e8a8f11ee57f>